

Construction Operations Research & Notice Preparation SOP

Operations SOP Knowledge Guide - Material #1

Version: 0.1 - Working Draft

Purpose: Knowledge source for the Construction Operations SOP & Training Coach

Audience: Research Team, QC Team, New Researchers and Operations Staff

Important: This document is based on the operational workflow supplied by the process owner for training and agent-design purposes. Detailed escalation rules, statutory/legal decision logic, and exception-specific procedures should be maintained in separately approved knowledge sources.

1. Purpose

This guide describes the operational workflow used to research construction Work Orders (WOs), establish relevant project participants and the contractual/payment chain, collect supporting evidence, prepare applicable notice information, and submit completed research for Quality Control (QC).

The guide provides a consistent understanding of how Work Orders enter research, how customer-provided information is reviewed, how property/NOC/permit/bond research is performed, how participants and payment chains are established, how evidence is retained, how WOs move through operational states, and how research is handed to QC.

This guide supports operational research and training. Detailed exception handling and escalation procedures belong in the separate Research Decision & Escalation Guide.

2. Work Order Assignment

Researchers work from individual research queues. Managers and the technology team assign Work Orders to researcher queues, normally as part of the weekly assignment process.

Before beginning external research, the researcher reviews the complete Job Sheet and understands the project information already supplied.

3. Work Order Lifecycle

The primary Work Order / notice workflow is:

Create Request -> Draft -> Request -> Processing -> Under Review -> Completed Notice -> Mailed

- Draft: Customer created a request but has not submitted it.
- Request: Submitted request awaiting researcher processing.
- Processing: Researcher has proceeded with the WO. It may remain here while additional research or confirmation is required.
- Under Review: Research and notice preparation are complete and the WO has been submitted to QC.
- Completed Notice: QC has validated the notice and pushed it to the print queue.
- Mailed: Applicable mailing process has been completed.
- HOLD: Used when the customer asks that processing be temporarily held.

4. Initial Job Sheet Review

Before performing external research, review the entire Job Sheet. The Job Sheet provides the starting information needed to understand the project and determine the appropriate research path.

5. Customer Information

The Job Sheet identifies the company's customer and normally includes the customer's name, address, and stated role on the project.

Possible roles include Supplier, Subcontractor, General Contractor, Equipment Supplier/Lessor, Labour Supplier, and other applicable project roles.

The role entered by the customer should not automatically be assumed to be correct. The researcher evaluates the stated role against the actual project structure and evidence obtained during research.

6. Customer's Customer (CC) Information

The Job Sheet also contains information about the Customer's Customer (CC), meaning the party that hired or contracted with the company's customer.

Available information may include name, role, address, phone number, email address, or both phone and email.

Possible roles include Property Manager, General Contractor, Owner, Owner/Builder, Subcontractor, and other project participants.

The researcher uses CC information as a key starting point for establishing the contractual/payment chain from the company's customer toward the owner or applicable public project participants.

7. Participant Role Analysis

Customer-provided roles may be incomplete or incorrect and must be validated against the researched project structure.

For example, a customer may be entered as a subcontractor even though the actual relationship shows the customer working for a property manager or another party directly associated with the owner.

Where supported by project evidence, roles should be corrected so the Work Order reflects the actual contractual hierarchy. Property ownership should be established from appropriate property records.

Where corporate/address verification is needed, approved corporate records may be reviewed.

8. Owner/Builder Situations

Some projects involve developers or entities acting as both owner and builder. In applicable situations, the same party may represent ownership and construction responsibility.

Where the project evidence supports this structure, the participant should be represented as Owner/Builder (O/B) rather than creating an unsupported separate General Contractor.

This may occur when suppliers, subcontractors, equipment providers, or labour providers work directly with residential developers or similar owner-builders.

9. Main Job Information

- **Job Address:** Physical project location where the customer's materials, labour, equipment, services, or work are being provided. It is a primary search key for property, mapping, NOC, permit, and project research.
- **Job Name:** May contain project name, subdivision, lot number, GC name, school/university/facility name, public project name, or another customer-created identifier. Researchers should use these details as research clues.
- **First Day on the Job:** Important project date that may affect notice/payment-rights deadlines. Researchers should not casually modify it. Deadline-related actions must follow approved requirements.
- **Job Amount:** Expected value of the customer's materials, labour, equipment, services, or work. It is generally preserved as customer-provided information unless an approved correction is required.
- **Materials Furnished:** Description of the materials, labour, equipment, services, or construction work supplied by the customer.

10. Project Classification

Project classification determines the appropriate research path.

- **Private:** Private Commercial; Private Residential.

- Public: State/County/Local Government; Federal.

State/County/Local projects may involve property or work owned by a state, county, town, village, municipality, or other applicable public entity.

Federal projects may include federal agencies or federally owned facilities/projects. Federal-project research should follow the approved federal process.

11. Existing Participants, Attachments and Notes

Customers may provide Owner, General Contractor, or other participant information. These fields may also be blank and left for research.

Customers may attach NOCs, permits, project documents, or other supporting information. An attached NOC must still be checked for relevance and whether a later/applicable NOC exists.

The Notes section may contain customer instructions, deadline context, customer/customer's-customer details, project clarification, or special processing information. Notes provide context but do not automatically override project evidence.

12. Research Step 1 - Analyse the Complete Job Sheet

Review Customer, customer role, Customer's Customer, CC role, Job Address, Job Name, First Day on Job, Job Amount, Project Type, Materials Furnished, existing participants, attachments, and notes.

The researcher should form an initial answer to two questions: Who hired whom? and What project is being researched?

13. Research Step 2 - Determine County and Official Sources

Identify the appropriate county using ZIP code, city, state, and project address information.

A public-record directory may be used to locate the appropriate county Property Appraiser and Official Records systems. Whenever possible, the underlying official county/public source should be used as the evidence source.

14. Property Card (PC) Research

The Property Card is an important source for establishing property information.

A PC may be located using Job Address, Owner Name, Subdivision, Lot Number, or other property identifiers.

Relevant information may include property owner, property address, folio/parcel information, legal description, and other relevant property information.

15. Mapping Process

When direct property searches are insufficient, mapping may be required.

1. Identify the project location using map/location information.
2. Use that location as a reference in the applicable county mapping/property system.
3. Identify the relevant parcel/property.
4. Retrieve the associated property information.

Mapping evidence may be retained with research documentation where appropriate.

16. Notice of Commencement (NOC) Research

For applicable private projects, search the county's Official Records for the relevant NOC.

Search criteria may include Owner name, General Contractor name, applicable date range, and other project identifiers.

The researcher must determine that the NOC reasonably corresponds to the WO before relying on it.

Relevant NOC information may include Owner, GC, project address, leasehold information, designated recipients, lender, surety-related information where present, recording/instrument information, and other applicable participants.

17. Permit Research

If an applicable NOC cannot be located, permit research may provide additional project evidence.

Search applicable county, municipal/town, or other official permitting systems.

Permit information may help confirm project location, contractor, project details, and other relevant information, especially when additional GC confirmation is needed.

18. Public Project / Bond Research

For applicable State/County public projects, research focuses on the applicable bond rather than private-property NOC research.

The researcher may use GC name, Job Name, public project information, and other identifying details. The Job Name can be particularly important for identifying the correct bond.

Relevant bond information may include General Contractor, Bond Company/Surety, Bond Number, Surety Agent, designated recipients, other applicable participants, and bond instrument/recording information where applicable.

19. When Primary Project Documents Cannot Be Located

If the expected NOC, permit, or bond evidence cannot be located, the researcher must not invent missing project information.

Depending on the project and available information, additional confirmation may be sought from the Customer's Customer, the customer, or other approved sources.

Detailed contact attempts, confirmation requirements, and escalation rules are defined in the Research Decision & Escalation Guide.

20. Customer's Customer Confirmation

For applicable commercial projects where sufficient documentary evidence cannot be located, the Customer's Customer may be contacted using approved communication methods.

The researcher may need to confirm the CC's role, whether they hired the company's customer, whether they are the GC, whether an NOC exists, or whether another party is involved in the contractual chain.

If the CC identifies another party, that information becomes a research lead and the researcher attempts to locate supporting project evidence.

Verbal or written statements should be documented according to approved procedure and should not be represented as documentary evidence when they are not.

21. Transition from Request to Processing

Once the researcher has sufficiently reviewed the Job Sheet and completed the required research path, the Work Order is opened for processing using the applicable action in the application.

The WO then moves from Request -> Processing.

22. Notice Preparation - Data Validation

Compare customer-provided information against research findings.

Correct applicable data-quality issues such as spelling errors, ZIP-code errors, project-type errors, and participant information where supported by research.

Do not change important customer-provided project information without an approved operational reason.

23. Validate Notice Type and Core Job Information

Check whether the selected notice type is appropriate for the project. The application may recommend a notice type, but the researcher still verifies it according to approved procedure.

Review First Day on Job, Job Amount, and Job Name. These are generally preserved as customer-provided information except for permitted data-quality corrections or other approved changes.

24. Add Property Information

Using the Property Card, add applicable Folio/Parcel Number and Legal Description information.

Accuracy is important because these fields become part of the researched WO record.

25. Attach Research Evidence

Research documents must be retained in the appropriate application sections.

- Research: Property Card, Maps, Reference Files.
- Notice of Commencement: NOC and applicable instrument/recording details.
- Bond: Bond document, bond instrument details, Bond Number, and other applicable bond information.

26. Establish the Contractual / Payment Hierarchy

This is one of the most important stages of Work Order preparation.

The researcher establishes the project relationship from the Owner/public entity through the relevant contracting parties to the company's customer.

Conceptually: Owner / Public Entity -> Project Participants -> Customer's Customer -> Our Customer.

The actual chain varies by project. Researchers must use evidence rather than forcing every project into the same hierarchy.

27. Private Project Participants

Depending on the PC, NOC, permit, and project information, participants may include Owner, Owner/Builder, General Contractor, Leasehold party, Tenant, Property Manager, Lender, Surety Agent, Designated Recipient, and other applicable participants.

If the Job Name or evidence identifies a commercial occupant such as a store, business, or facility, evaluate whether that party should be represented as a tenant according to approved procedure.

Only participants relevant to the project should be added.

28. Public / Bond Project Participants

For applicable bonded public projects, participants may include Public Owner, General Contractor, Bond Company/Surety, Surety Agent, Designated Recipient, and other applicable bond/project participants.

The contractual/payment hierarchy must accurately represent the researched project structure.

29. Final Researcher Review

Before submitting to QC, recheck Job Address, project classification, participant names/spelling, supporting evidence, Folio/Legal information, NOC/Bond details, contractual/payment hierarchy, attached documents, and the notice preview.

Once satisfied, submit the WO for review. The state changes from Processing -> Under Review.

30. Quality Control (QC) Process

A QC team member retrieves the WO from the review queue and compares the prepared notice against the supporting attachments and researched documentation.

The QC reviewer validates the completed notice rather than simply repeating data entry.

31. QC Validation Areas

QC validation includes applicable checks for Job Address, County, spelling, suite/unit information, Project Type, Notice Type, Job Amount, Job Name, Folio, Legal Description, attachments, NOC Instrument Number for applicable private/commercial projects, Bond Number for applicable public projects, participants, contractual hierarchy, payment chain, and the overall notice.

32. QC Completion

When QC determines that the notice is correctly prepared, the reviewer uses the applicable action to push it to the print queue.

The WO moves from Under Review -> Completed Notice and then proceeds through the applicable mailing process.

33. Core Research Principles

Analyse before searching. Understand the WO before beginning external research.

Customer data is a starting point. Roles and participant information may be incorrect or incomplete.

Establish the actual project structure. Do not force every project into the same Owner -> GC -> Subcontractor pattern.

Use supporting evidence. Use appropriate PC, NOC, permit, bond, and other approved sources.

Do not guess. If information cannot be established, follow the approved research and escalation procedure.

Preserve evidence. Attach relevant documents to the correct WO sections.

Build the correct payment chain. Participant hierarchy is a critical part of notice preparation.

Review before submission. Use the notice preview and supporting evidence for a final self-review.

Maintain human review. Ambiguous, conflicting, or unsupported situations should be escalated rather than resolved by assumption.

34. High-Level Process Flow

WO Assigned -> Review Job Sheet -> Understand Customer/CC/Project -> Classify Project -> Research Evidence -> Validate Participants -> Establish Payment Chain -> Resolve/Escalate Missing Evidence -> Processing -> Prepare Notice -> Attach Evidence -> Build Hierarchy -> Self-QC -> Under Review -> Independent QC -> Completed Notice -> Mailing -> Mailed

35. Related Knowledge Documents

This SOP should be used together with: (1) Research Decision & Escalation Guide, (2) QC Checklist, (3) Construction Operations Terminology & Knowledge Glossary, and (4) Synthetic Training & Agent Evaluation Scenarios.

Together, these documents form the knowledge foundation for the Construction Operations SOP & Training Coach.